

messaging overall. We're only just starting to monetise WhatsApp. That's really early days for us. And we've created some new products, like Click to WhatsApp.

Q: What would be the typical WhatsApp revenue model? Will we start seeing ads on WhatsApp?

A: I want to be careful of even using the word ad, because I think one of the successes of our platforms is that we want our advertising to be native to the individual platform... One of the things we have at the moment is Click to WhatsApp. So you can be on Facebook and [it can] literally take you into a thread on WhatsApp. All types of businesses are organically already working on WhatsApp... we look at what the current behaviours are, what people are doing, how they're reacting and interacting with businesses, and then we'll look to see how we can create different solutions for larger advertisers as well.

Q: We've seen changes in Apple's privacy policy that will hit your business. How do you plan to overcome that?

A: We've been very vocal for a long time about the fact that what Apple did has really had a disproportionate effect on all businesses around the world—not just ours—and especially small businesses. And it's been very clear that Apple wanted to create an app business. And they have. And they don't adhere to the policies that they make for everybody else. That said, we're doing a number of things. We've been doubling down on privacy-enhanced technologies, so that we can do more with less data going forward. We already give strong ROI to our advertisers, but we want to continue doing so. We're also doubling down on the investment in AI. There are two parts to this: one is what content we serve to people. And the other is what advertising we serve. By using AI, we're able to serve the best ads to people, which is good for them and also good for the advertiser. Plus, we've been talking about the new formats that we can offer to advertisers in terms of how to communicate.

Q: Talking of privacy, do you think there is an inherent contradiction between your advertising models and the privacy aspect?

ON NEW MONETISATION OPPORTUNITIES

We are focussing on Reels. We're starting to see the monetisation of Reels with things like collaborative ads. There is also excitement around messaging. We are starting to monetise WhatsApp. We have created some new products, like Click to WhatsApp.

ON APPLE'S NEW POLICY

What Apple did has had a disproportionate effect on all businesses around the world. Apple doesn't adhere to the policies that it makes for everybody else. We are doubling down on privacy-enhanced technologies, so that we can do more with less data. We are also increasing investment in AI.

ON PRIVACY

We take privacy very seriously. Anybody on the platform [can] do a privacy check. When you see an ad you can find out why you are seeing that ad with just a click. And if you don't want to see it, you have that option as well. We've built these things over the years into our platforms, because privacy matters to us.

A: This [privacy] is something that we take very seriously. Anybody on the platform [can] do a privacy checkup. You also have the option when you see an ad from somebody, you can literally click on the top right corner, there's a feature saying, 'why am I seeing this ad', and it will explain it away. And then, if you don't want to see ads from an advertiser, or a category, you have the option to be able to do that. These are the sort of things that we've built over the years into our platforms, because we know it matters to consumers. And so it matters to us as well.

What will the metaverse do for your advertising revenues? How will AR/VR and the metaverse change the entire advertising outlook for Meta?

A: I honestly think it's too early to say, but what is clear as we move into Web 3.0 [is the disruption it will bring]... Klaus Schwab, at the World Economic Forum, said that we're at the dawn of a fourth industrial revolution. And if you look back on the previous industrial revolutions, I think it's disrupted every aspect of our lives, not just advertising. I think we'll see another very exciting disruption. And you've seen from the vision our Founder is setting out [is] that we want to be one of the companies that's playing a part in doing that. But we won't do it alone. [We'll do it] with other companies, NGOs, governments and creators. What's different is that this time Web 3.0 will be built by creators.

What are the key areas India will play a role in the evolution of Meta?

A: I think it's about the disruption already that Indian creators and the Indian creative economy is having... So many of the top-followed people on Instagram don't live in the major cities. That's a disruption on the Indian economy itself... But they're not just influencing in India, they're influencing in other parts of the world as well. We see things like the dance crazes, comedy and fashion now starting to come out of India and going to the rest of the world. That's where the difference lies this time around. And that's why it's really an exciting time to be in India. **BT**

@TheSouravM, @abhik_sen

This interview took place before Meta announced its Q3 2022 results